

OFFICIAL MAINTENANCE PROCEDURES

ICH Impurity Guidelines

Updating and keeping Q3C, Q3D, and M7 Guidelines Current

Pharmaceutical Analysis & Regulatory Affairs

| Scope of the Maintenance Procedure



Q3C

Residual Solvents Control and establishment of PDE Limits.



Q3D

Elemental Impurities management for heavy metals and safety limits.



M7 Addendum

Assessment and control of DNA reactive (mutagenic) impurities.

| Allowed Revision Categories

GUIDELINE	SPECIFIC ALLOWED CHANGES
Q3C (Solvents)	Adding PDE limits for new solvents or revising existing PDEs based on new toxicology.
Q3D (Metals)	Incorporating PDEs for new elements, routes, or revising limits as toxicity findings evolve.
M7 (Mutagenic)	Adding AI or PDE limits for new mutagenic impurities or updating limits with new data.

| The Proposal Submission Channel



Channels

Proposals are submitted directly to the **ICH Secretariat**.



Eligibility

Open to any **ICH Member, Observer**, or interested stakeholders.



Requirement

Must be supported by **high-quality toxicological data**.

| Drug Regulatory Affairs (DRA) Roles



The image shows the ICH logo with the text "ICH" and "harmonisation for better h" below it. Below the logo are three stylized icons of healthcare workers wearing masks and caps, each with a heart and ECG line above their head.

Regulatory Specialist

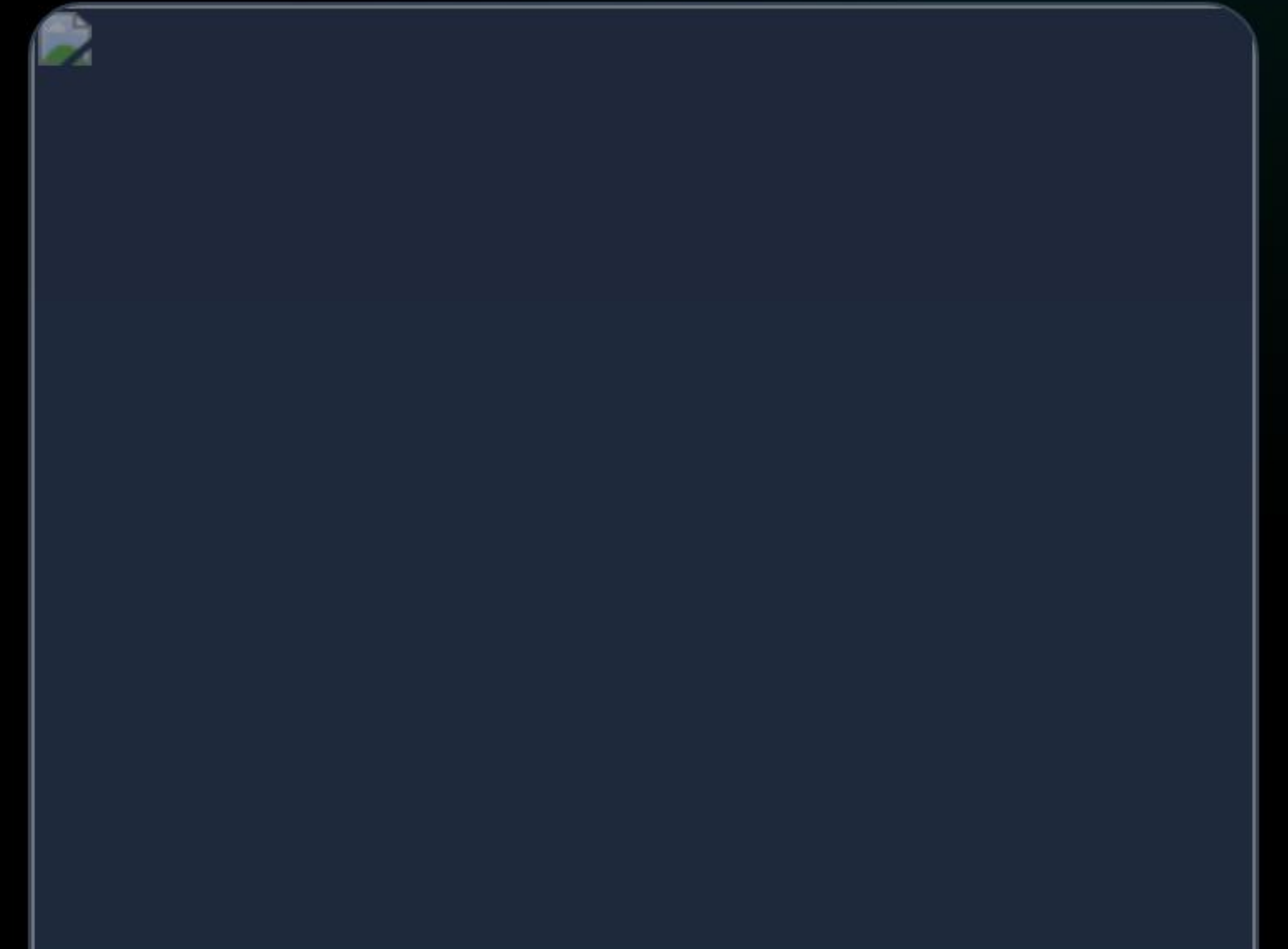
Ensures compliance and data integrity.



A woman in a red top and black blazer is speaking to a group of people in a meeting room.

Regulatory Manager

Obtains drug approvals and monitors compliance.



A dark blue rectangular area representing the Compliance Officer role.

Compliance Officer

Oversees surveillance and standards.

| Safety Data Acceptance Standards

✔ Accepted Data

- Repeat-dose toxicity studies
- Reproductive toxicity studies
- Genotoxicity & Carcinogenicity (M7 focus)
- **Reproducible scientific proof**

✘ Prohibited Data

Single-dose toxicity data alone cannot be used to calculate or change a PDE or AI.

ICH will not initiate a change without strong, reproducible proof sufficient to alter limits.

| Expert Working Group Evaluation



Core Composition

A dedicated EWG evaluates every proposal received, following strict ICH SOPs for scientific consensus.

-  **Core Membership:** Consistent, SOP-guided experts.
-  **Observer Input:** Can nominate experts to join.
-  **Leadership:** Founding Member Rapporteur.

| Leadership Rotation & Review Timeline



| Strict Evaluation Filters



Significant Impact

Revisions only considered if new data causes major shifts in limits or proves old data invalid.



No Minor Changes

The group does not waste resources on insignificant or numerically small PDE tweaks.



Digital First

Uses email, document sharing, and video calls primarily to save time and reduce travel.

| Standard Approval Workflow

-  **Internal Review & Sharing:** Secretariat shares data with the EWG and Rapporteur.
-  **EWG Work Plan:** Developed and submitted to the Management Committee (MC).
-  **Assembly Approval:** The formal ICH body endorses the proposed revisions.
-  **Official Assessment Report:** The Rapporteur summarizes consensus to accept, modify, or reject.

Step 3 Process: Once endorsed, the proposal enters Step 3 of the ICH process for global public consultation.

| Transparency and Regional Adoption

Global Connectivity

Once the Assembly approves, the recommendation is published in each global region for comprehensive public comment.

📖 **Pharmacopoeias:** Proposals shared with international bodies simultaneously.

🛡️ **Strict Consistency:** Only exact changes or new addendums are listed.

🌐 **Implementation:** Follows local regional practices.

 Global Network Connectivity Map





Information Dissemination

Approved PDE or AI limits are rapidly transmitted via the ICH Official Website, international pharmacopoeias, and online member sites to ensure industry compliance.

For detailed updates, visit www.ich.org

Maintenance of Q3C, Q3D, and M7 | 2025 Review Cycle

| Image Sources



<https://img1.wsimg.com/isteam/ip/16ddb08-5933-40a2-b605-3a9895a8b8d6/ich.jpg/:cr=t:0%25,l:0%25,w:100%25,h:100%25/rs=w:1280>

Source: pharmdacademy.org



<https://www.cahillconsultants.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/Industry-and-Regulatory-Training.jpg>

Source: www.cahillconsultants.com



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